

WHERE I AM NOT SUPPOSED TO BE

A Story of One School Year

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Where I Am Not Supposed to Be

A literary adaptation of a true school-year memory

By Dequinte

Author's Note

This book is based on Otiano's remembered experiences during one year of secondary school. The major people, relationships, turning points, and outcomes are kept according to the story provided by the author. Some dialogue, transitions, atmosphere, and internal reflections are reconstructed as literary writing rather than presented as word-for-word transcripts.

The purpose is not to make the year look perfect. It is to preserve it—the mistakes, friendships, confusion, affection, consequences, and the people who made the year what it was.

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1. The Staff Room

Sometimes being removed from one place is how you discover another part of yourself. The chair in the staff room was harder than it looked. Otiano sat on it with his hands together, trying to keep them still. The room was quiet in the particular way a room becomes quiet when everyone inside already knows that something important has happened. Across from him sat the headmaster. Beside and behind him were Otiano's parents. Nobody had come to argue. Nobody had come to shout. The meeting had already passed the point where shouting could change anything. The headmaster looked at Otiano for a moment before speaking. "Your discipline is not fit for this school." Otiano lowered his eyes. "You are not supposed to be here in this school. You need to search for another school."

The words were simple. They did not need to be explained. Otiano had known, somewhere inside himself, that his behavior could eventually bring him here. He had never imagined that the ending would feel so quiet. There was no dramatic scene, no crowd outside the door, no final chance to bargain. There was only a chair, a staff room, his parents, and a decision. The headmaster turned toward his parents. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. "If he does not change," he warned, "there will be many consequences in life." Otiano heard every word. He wanted to say something. His mouth opened slightly, then closed again. When he finally tried to speak, the words caught somewhere between his thoughts and his voice. He had nothing useful to say anyway. His parents already knew his behavior. They had not come to the school shocked by a story they had never heard.

They had known there were problems. They had spoken with him before. Their relationship had always allowed them to talk openly, but knowing your child is struggling with his behavior is not the same as watching a

school decide that the child must leave. Otiano remained quiet. The headmaster's voice became calmer. "Think about what happens next." Otiano nodded. That was all. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. He stood up and left the staff room without making a scene. Outside, the school looked almost exactly as it always had. Students moved through corridors. Voices came from classrooms. Shoes struck the floor. Somewhere, someone laughed. The ordinary sounds made the moment stranger.

Some students cried when they learned he was leaving. Others came to him with respect, saying goodbye and thanking him for the memories they had shared. Otiano accepted it quietly. He did not return to class. He went home, entered the living room, and began packing his clothes. He did not know that he was closing one chapter of his life. He only knew that he was leaving.

2. Leaving

The clothes went into the bag one after another. A shirt. Another shirt. Trousers. Shoes. The small things that normally belonged to an ordinary school trip suddenly looked like pieces of a life that had been interrupted. Otiano did not stand in the middle of the room and cry. He was not that kind of person. He moved quietly, almost mechanically, while his thoughts moved much faster than his hands. He thought about the students who had cried. He thought about the ones who had said goodbye. He thought about the teachers.

He thought about the fact that he would never walk back through those corridors as a student. His parents did not need to give him a long speech. They knew him, and he knew them. There was disappointment, but there was also communication. They wanted him to understand that leaving the school was not the end of his education. It was a consequence. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. Otiano listened. Then he carried his things to the car. The driver was waiting. When the car began moving, Otiano looked out of the window. The road continued forward while everything behind him became smaller. He did not know the name of the school that would become his new world in the same emotional way he knew the old one. He only knew that he was going somewhere else.

A cheaper school. A different environment. A different beginning. He would later understand that sometimes a person can leave a place without realizing how much the place has shaped them. For Otiano, the old school had been part of his identity. He was the rich kid. The confident one. The ladies' guy. The lover boy. The boy who could spend money without thinking too much about what another student might have to sacrifice to have the same amount. Now he was going somewhere where those things would be noticed. The ordinary details mattered too.

A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. The journey took about an hour. For most of it, Otiano stayed quiet. He watched buildings change, streets pass, people walk, and ordinary life continue.

He wondered what the students at the new school would think of him. Then another thought came. What if nobody cared? That possibility felt almost funny. He smiled slightly. Then the car stopped. Greenspring A Secondary School was in front of him.

3. Greenspring

Otiano stepped out wearing his uniform. For a moment he simply looked at the school. It was not the place he had imagined for himself. The difference was visible immediately. The buildings, the atmosphere, the way students moved around the school—it all felt less polished than the environment he had known. But it was still a school. Students were studying. Teachers were teaching. People were laughing. Life was happening. A staff member took him toward the staff room. Otiano expected paperwork, instructions, perhaps an introduction. Instead, the first lesson came in a different form.

The staff member knew Otiano came from a wealthy family and from a richer school. The staff member decided to make an example of him. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. “Get down.” Otiano looked at him. “Kneel.” He knelt. Then came the instruction to cut his nails using his teeth. The humiliation was obvious. But Otiano did not give the reaction that was expected. He simply did it. He had already lost one school. He was not going to fight over a few nails. When it was finished, he stood up, dusted himself off, and walked back toward class.

Nobody in the student body had watched it happen. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. That mattered. Otiano did not have to enter the classroom carrying a story about being humiliated. He could simply enter as the new student. He found his seat. Then he saw Olivier. Olivier was the only person there he had known from primary school. The familiarity was a relief. Then there was Irene, another friend he would quickly become comfortable with. “Bro,” Olivier said, looking at him. Otiano smiled. He had arrived.

And for the first time since leaving his old school, he felt that maybe the year would not be as bad as he had imagined.

4. The Rich Kid

Greenspring did not take long to understand that Otiano was different. Not necessarily better. Different. People noticed the way he dressed. They noticed that he was comfortable with money. They knew he had come from a richer school. Some treated him like a normal student. Others treated him like the rich kid. Otiano did not hate the label. In fact, sometimes he enjoyed it. Money had always been part of the way people understood him. At lunch, however, the difference became impossible to ignore. The food was not what he was used to. Sometimes Justin and Chriss joked about him because of it. They knew he had come from a place where things

were different. Otiano would laugh. He could afford to complain. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. He could afford to buy something else. That was the strange thing about being wealthy in a place where many people were not. Money did not disappear simply because you entered a poorer environment. If anything, its power became more visible. Otiano spent money on the things he liked. Girls. Food. Grooming. Skin care. Looking clean. Looking good.

Looking like himself. His confidence grew. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. He knew French well, and teachers generally liked him for that. Students began to recognize him. He became popular. Not because he had arrived with a speech about who he was. He became popular because he carried himself as if he already knew. Irene and Olivier stayed close. With them, Otiano did not have to perform. He could laugh. He could talk. He could be the same boy who had arrived that morning wondering whether anyone would accept him.

As the first weeks passed, the school stopped feeling completely foreign. Then, after about one week, Otiano met Nanette.

5. Nanette

His friends introduced the idea before they introduced the girl.

They told Otiano about Nanette. She was popular, attractive, and the kind of girl people noticed. They gave him her contact and told him she was the type of girl who would fit him.

Otiano was interested.

Then he met her.

The beginning was simple. No dramatic declaration. No promise that either of them understood. They talked, laughed, and slowly became comfortable around each other. Nanette liked his confidence. Otiano liked the way she gave him attention without asking him to become someone else.

Soon, friendship became something closer.

They walked together at school. They sat together. They visited each other's places. Their conversations became more personal. There were ordinary moments that did not seem important at the time: a look across a classroom, a smile when one of them arrived, a conversation that lasted longer than expected because neither wanted to be the first to leave.

For a while, Nanette had every reason to believe that Otiano was giving her his attention because she mattered to him.

And she did matter to him.

But Otiano had a weakness he had not learned to control.

He loved attention.

Even when he was happy with one person, part of him still wanted to know that other people wanted him. Fame mattered to him too—the

feeling of being known, noticed, talked about. He liked being the boy people recognized. He liked the reputation of being the ladies' guy.

Nanette could not see all of that at first.

She saw the boy who made her laugh. The boy who spent time with her. The boy who could make an ordinary school day feel exciting.

Otiano saw the good parts too. He just did not understand how much damage the other parts could cause.

As the school year continued, another girl caught his attention.

And that was where the first crack began.

6. Delice's Smile

It had been about a month since Otiano arrived at Greenspring.

He was walking near a classroom when he noticed a group of girls gathered together. Their voices mixed with the ordinary noise of school—shoes against the floor, students calling to each other, laughter coming from somewhere down the corridor.

Then he saw Delice.

She was listening to a story, and then she smiled.

Otiano stopped without meaning to.

It was not simply that she was beautiful. It was the way her face changed when she smiled. Her eyes seemed to brighten before the smile fully reached her mouth. For a second, the rest of the corridor felt less important.

He watched her laugh with the others.

She looked away while another girl continued the story. Then she looked back, and the smile returned.

Otiano found himself wondering what it would take to make her smile like that because of him.

That thought stayed with him.

He joined the group.

Delice was friendly. She did not treat him like the rich kid who had arrived from another school. She talked to him naturally, and that made it easier for him to stay near her.

So Otiano became her friend.

At first, he told himself that was enough.

Then he started noticing the small things.

The way Delice listened before answering. The way she sometimes lowered her eyes when she laughed. The way she could be surrounded by people and still make a conversation feel like it belonged only to the two people speaking.

Otiano began looking for her without admitting that he was looking.

If he entered a classroom, his eyes searched for her first.

If he heard laughter nearby, he wondered if it was hers.

If she smiled at him, even briefly, he carried that moment longer than he should have.

And without asking permission from his own heart, he fell in love.

There was only one problem.

Delice loved someone else.

His name was Fis.

Fis was also new at the school and was in S6, although not in Delice's class. He was popular, and people liked him. Otiano and Fis were friends.

Fis did not know that Otiano loved Delice.

Delice did not know that Otiano knew she loved Fis.

That made the feeling heavier.

Otiano was close enough to Delice to hear her laugh, close enough to notice her smile, close enough to hope—and still not the person she had chosen in her heart.

He once tried to kiss her.

She refused.

For a moment, embarrassment burned through him. He stepped back. He did not force anything. He stayed her friend.

Sometimes the hardest part of caring about someone is accepting that their feelings belong to them.

So he stayed.

He joked with her. He walked with her. He listened. He kept hoping, even when hope hurt.

Then one day they were walking home.

Otiano made her laugh.

It was one of those moments where laughter comes easily, where the conversation has no pressure and the walk feels shorter than it should.

When they reached their destination, they stopped.

For a second, neither seemed ready to end the moment.

They hugged.

Then Delice kissed him.

For Otiano, everything seemed to stop.

He remembered the warmth of the moment, the surprise in his own heart, and the dangerous little thought that arrived immediately afterward:

Maybe this means something.

Maybe everything has changed.

He looked at her afterward, trying to read an answer from her face.

But later he understood that the kiss had not changed what she felt.

It had only been a kiss.

For him, it became a memory he would carry much longer than she probably realized.

And that was the cruel part of loving someone whose heart was somewhere else: one small moment could mean everything to you while meaning something completely different to them.

7. Sarada

Sarada was different from Delice.

She was Delice's best friend, but she was her own person.

She watched Otiano chase Delice. She watched him try. She watched him get disappointed. And when he did not know what to do with himself, Sarada stayed around.

She listened.

She told him things about Delice. She answered questions when she could. She saw the way his mood changed whenever Delice entered a room.

Sometimes Otiano did not even have to explain what had happened. Sarada could see it in his face.

A good moment with Delice made him bright.

A disappointing moment made him quiet.

She became the person who could sit beside him without demanding an explanation.

That friendship grew quietly.

Otiano sometimes called Sarada his second love, but the truth was more complicated.

Delice was the person he truly loved.

Sarada was the person who loved him.

Those two facts could exist at the same time.

Otiano did not understand yet what that would mean for his future.

He only knew that Sarada was becoming important.

She was there when his confidence disappeared. She was there when he needed someone to talk to. She knew the part of him that was tired of pretending everything was easy.

And because she was always there, he slowly stopped noticing how rare that kind of presence was.

Until much later.

8. Lavie

Lavie met Otiano in class during a moment when the teacher was out.

He noticed her and thought she looked good. He decided to become her friend.

It was easy.

Lavie listened.

Otiano talked.

He told stories about relationships.

And because Otiano liked looking experienced, he sometimes lied.

He wanted to appear like the ladies' guy everyone thought he was. He told Lavie stories about dates with Nanette. Some of those stories were not true.

At the time, the lies felt small.

That was the danger.

A lie can feel harmless while it is still inside the mouth of the person telling it. It becomes something else when another person carries it away.

Otiano trusted Lavie.

After his relationship with Nanette ended, he remained single while his friendship with Delice and Sarada continued. He spoke with Lavie about his past relationships and about things he had done.

But he made one distinction.

He said he had never done those things with Nanette.

Lavie took what she knew and carried it back to Nanette.

She told Nanette everything.

The dates.

The stories.

The things Otiano had claimed.

The lies.

Nanette was hurt.

The relationship had already ended, but now the ending had become something more bitter.

Lavie had chosen her side.

Otiano did not confront her. He did not fight. He simply continued living, unaware of how much pain the information had created.

9. Nanette's Hurt

Nanette did not forget.

When Lavie told her what Otiano had said, her first reaction was not quiet sadness.

She got upset.

“What the fuck? This is a mess. That guy is not normal. His brain is like a kid.”

The words came from anger, but underneath the anger was something much more painful.

She had loved him.

That was the first thing.

Then came sadness.

She began thinking about everything they had shared. The conversations. The time together. The moments when she believed his attention meant something deeper. She remembered the version of Otiano she had loved, and now she had to place that version beside the stories Lavie had brought her.

Then the sadness became anger.

Nanette began to think about revenge.

Not because she wanted to destroy him physically. She wanted him to feel something—to understand that his choices had consequences and that the person he treated as part of his fame and reputation was a real person who could be hurt.

In her mind, the problem became clear.

Otiano had lied about her.

He had treated her love as if it were something he could use while chasing attention.

And, in Nanette's eyes, fame seemed to matter to him more than the love she had given him.

She did not understand how someone could receive genuine affection and still keep looking around to see who else was watching.

So she started planning.

Mamy became involved.

Lavie became involved too.

But Nanette was the master planner.

She did not want Otiano to see the trap coming. She wanted everything to look normal until the moment it was too late to escape the conversation.

They would make him believe there was a party.

He would come willingly.

He would expect laughter, people, and an ordinary night.

Instead, he would walk into the consequences of everything Nanette had been carrying.

While the plan grew, Nanette and Otiano became strangers in the same school.

They never looked each other in the eyes.

Not once.

They could pass each other in a corridor and both look away. They could be in the same place and behave as if the other person were not there.

That silence said more than an argument could have.

Nanette had no final secret move beyond the plan. There was no hidden gesture Otiano failed to understand. She simply wanted him to feel the weight of what he had done.

For Nanette, the order of emotions had been simple but brutal:

First love.

Second sadness.

Third anger.

And anger gave her the courage to finish the plan.

Otiano knew none of this.

He walked through school with his usual confidence. He laughed with friends. He moved as if nothing could surprise him.

He did not know that Nanette, with Lavie beside her and Mamy helping, was preparing the night that would change the way he looked at himself.

10. Katia

The secret began with group work. A teacher placed Otiano and Katia in the same group. They were already comfortable around each other. The closeness became different. Otiano crossed a boundary by trying to touch her in a way meant to arouse her. Katia allowed it. What followed became a secret relationship. Four weeks. It happened in the middle of the third term. Otiano was already in love with Delice. He was still developing his friendship with Sarada. Yet he had another girl hidden from them. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had

changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. Katia became his side relationship. It was something Otiano knew he could not tell the others. Delice never suspected. Sarada never suspected. Nanette did not know. Lavie did not know. Mamy did not know. That secrecy became part of Otiano's life. For four weeks, he carried two different versions of himself. The one people saw. And the one he kept hidden. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you

know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. Then Katia moved to another city. The relationship ended because distance changed the situation. There was no dramatic goodbye that Otiano could turn into a story. It simply became another memory. The secret stayed with him. By then, Otiano had begun to understand something about himself. He could want one person and still hurt another. He could say one thing and do another. He could look confident while being confused inside. The problem was no longer the school. The problem was becoming the person he was choosing to be.

11. The Wrong Table

Otiano's money made him comfortable. Sometimes too comfortable. He could spend an amount of money on one dinner that another student might need for school fees. He knew this. He could see it. Yet knowing the difference did not always make him act differently. Greenspring had students who worried about paying fees. Otiano worried about girls, food, grooming, and how he looked. The contrast stayed in the background of his year. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed.

He was not treated exactly like everyone else. Sometimes students saw him as the rich kid. Sometimes they treated him normally. He could laugh about it, but there were moments when he wondered whether he truly belonged. That question became connected to the title he would eventually give his story. Where am I not supposed to be? He had been removed from one school because of his behavior. Now he was in another school that he had once imagined as beneath him. But perhaps the real question was not whether Greenspring was the wrong school. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. Perhaps the question was whether Otiano had become the wrong version of himself.

He did not know the answer yet. He was still running. Running from consequences. Running between friendships. Running between girls. Running from the quiet moment when he might have to admit that money could not fix every mistake. Then came the party.

12. The Fake Party

A person can laugh all year and still have a night that makes him sit quietly.

Mamy's place was supposed to be full of people.

At least, that was what Otiano believed.

The invitation felt ordinary enough.

He went.

He arrived expecting a party, not a reckoning.

Then the atmosphere changed.

He was taken into a dark room.

"Wait here."

The door closed.

Otiano looked around.

The darkness made every sound feel closer. He could hear voices outside, but he could not yet see the faces waiting for him.

Then the voices became clearer.

It was not a party.

It was a confrontation.

Nanette was there.

Lavie was there.

Mamy was there.

Nanette had planned it. Lavie had helped. Mamy had provided the place.

They talked about what he had done.

They talked about the lies.

They talked about the way he had treated girls.

For the first time, Otiano could not turn the moment into a joke.

His money could not buy his way out.

His confidence could not make the room disappear.

His reputation could not protect him.

He had to listen.

He thought about Nanette.

He thought about Lavie.

He thought about the version of himself who had enjoyed being famous among girls without thinking deeply about what that attention cost other people.

Nanette did not need to shout every second. The fact that she had planned the entire thing was enough.

The person he had once ignored now had control of the room.

And Otiano finally understood something uncomfortable: people remember the things you do even after you stop thinking about them.

When it was over, he went home.

He did not want to forget the night.

So he opened his computer.

And he wrote.

Not because he knew he was going to become an author.

Not because he had a publishing plan.

He wrote because he wanted the memory to stay somewhere outside his head.

13. The Day After

The next morning, Otiano went to school normally.

That was the strange part.

The classrooms were still there. Teachers still taught. Students still laughed. People carried books through the corridors as if nothing important had happened.

But Otiano felt different.

He spent the entire day thinking about Sarada.

Not Nanette.

Not Lavie.

Not Katia.

Sarada.

He remembered the way she had stayed beside him when he was disappointed. He remembered how she listened. He remembered how she loved him without needing him to perform for an audience.

He began thinking about something he had avoided for a long time.

Choosing one person.

Two days after the fake party, he was doing homework at home with Sarada. Delice was there too.

The room felt normal at first.

Books were open. Pens moved across pages. Someone asked a question about the work. There was nothing dramatic in the scene.

Then Delice decided to leave.

The door closed behind her.

Silence settled into the room.

Otiano looked at Sarada.

She looked back.

For a moment, neither spoke.

There were things both of them had been carrying for a long time.

Otiano breathed slowly.

"I want to tell you something, but I don't know how to start."

Sarada stayed quiet, giving him space.

He was afraid.

Afraid of losing her.

Afraid of being hurt again.

Afraid that saying the words would change the friendship they already had.

He looked at her face and saw the patience he had come to depend on.

Then he said it.

"I love you."

Sarada's expression changed.

Not dramatically. Just enough for him to see the relief and emotion arrive together.

"I love you too."

The words were simple.

The meaning was not.

Otiano had chosen Sarada because she loved him and because he wanted to try to love her.

But inside himself, he knew something he did not say aloud.

He did not know whether the love he had felt for Delice could ever become the same kind of love with Sarada.

He kept that truth to himself.

14. One Girl

After the party, Otiano stopped running around with girls.

The change was not immediate perfection.

It was a decision.

He wanted to focus on one person.

Sarada.

And slowly, ordinary moments began to feel important.

They walked at night under the open sky. Sometimes they did not need a big conversation. Being beside each other was enough.

They went to the lake, just the two of them. The water reflected the changing light while they talked, laughed, and stayed close. Otiano could look at Sarada and feel the strange comfort of knowing someone had chosen him even after seeing some of his worst sides.

They studied for national exams.

Sometimes they went home late, holding hands, with Sarada on Otiano's back when she was tired. They bought ice cream. They bought street food. They laughed at small things that would have looked meaningless to anyone else.

But those moments belonged to them.

At school, Delice remained his friend.

Sometimes Otiano still noticed her smile.

Sometimes that smile could still change his mood before he remembered himself and returned his attention to Sarada.

That old feeling did not disappear simply because he had made a decision.

Nanette did not know all of what happened after the party.

Lavie did not know everything.

Mamy did not know everything.

Katia was already in another city.

Otiano carried some parts of his past alone.

That was not necessarily noble.

It was simply what he chose.

With Sarada, he was trying to build something real from the present instead of constantly chasing the next person who might give him attention.

They held hands.

They studied.

They walked.

They laughed.

And sometimes, when Sarada looked at him, Otiano wondered whether love could grow because a person decided to give it time.

He did not know the answer yet.

He only knew that, for now, he was choosing one girl.

15. National Exams

The closer the national exams came, the more serious school became. Books replaced some of the gossip. Revision replaced some of the wandering. Otiano studied with Sarada. Irene and Olivier worked hard too. The friendships formed at Greenspring had become part of Otiano's final year. History was his subject. Law was still the dream waiting beyond school. He imagined himself in another environment one day, wearing a different kind of confidence. Not the confidence that came from money. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person

he had been before it changed. A confidence built from knowledge. Otiano thought about his future. Sarada wanted to become a lawyer too. Delice had her own future. Irene and Olivier were working toward opportunities that might take them abroad. The school year that had begun with humiliation and uncertainty was moving toward an ending none of them could stop. Otiano sometimes remembered the first day. The staff room. The instruction to kneel. The nails. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter.

The walk into class. It seemed far away now. He had arrived thinking the school was beneath him. But the school had given him friendships. It had given him mistakes. It had given him pain. It had given him memories. Most importantly, it had given him a story. He did not yet know that the story itself might become part of his future.

16. The People Around Him

Otiano looked at the people around him differently as graduation approached. Irene was still Irene. Supportive. Present. Olivier remained the friend who connected him to an older part of his life because they had known each other since primary school. Delice was still Delice. Her smile could still change Otiano's mood. Sarada was still beside him. Their relationship was peaceful. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed.

Fis remained someone Otiano respected. He never knew how deeply Otiano had once loved Delice. Nanette had become a road Otiano no longer walked. Lavie was a lesson about trust. Mamy was connected to the night that had changed him. Katia was a secret that had ended in another city. Every person had left something behind. Otiano realized that a school year was not measured only by lessons and exams. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. It was measured by the people who became part of your memory. Some stayed. Some left.

Some hurt you. Some loved you. Some taught you without knowing they were teaching. And some made you become the person you had been avoiding.

17. Graduation

Graduation arrived. The day felt unreal. Otiano stood among students who had spent a year becoming familiar to him. The boy who had arrived from a wealthy school was not exactly the same boy standing there now. He had lost relationships. He had gained others. He had lied. He had been lied about. He had hurt people. He had been hurt. He had fallen in love. He had chosen someone.

Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. He had learned that choosing someone and loving someone were not always identical. Sarada was there. Delice was there. Irene was there. Olivier was there. For Otiano and Sarada, this was their last school moment together. For Otiano and Delice, it was also the final school memory. Irene and Olivier were leaving with educational scholarships to study abroad. The future was opening in different directions. Otiano looked around.

Greenspring had once felt like the place where he was not supposed to be. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. Now it was the place that held one of the most important years of his life. He thought about the first day. He almost smiled. Sometimes the place you resist becomes the place that teaches you the most. The ceremony continued. Names were called. Students moved forward. Photographs were taken. People smiled. Then, slowly, the day began to end.

18. After School

School ended, but the story did not. Otiano and Sarada continued to love each other after school. They were still a couple. They still had the memories of the lake, the walks, the ice cream, the studying, the hands held on the way home. But life outside school was different. There were no classrooms forcing them to see each other. No bell deciding when they would meet. No corridor where a smile could begin a conversation. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. The future was now open.

Otiano thought about Delice sometimes. He did not talk about it. Some feelings become quiet without disappearing completely. Sarada was the person beside him now. He had chosen her. He was trying to love her. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. And that was where the story had to stop. Not because everything was solved. Not because every feeling had found a perfect answer. But because real life does not always provide an ending while you are living it. Sometimes you only know what is true today. Tomorrow remains unwritten.

19. The Computer

At home, Otiano opened his computer. The document was still there. The first words he had written after the fake party. He read them again. Then he began adding more. The staff room. The old school. The car. The road. Greenspring. Irene. Olivier. Nanette. Delice.

Sarada. Lavie. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. Katia. Mamy. Fis. The friendships. The lies. The kiss. The secret. The party. The graduation. He realized that the year had been too complicated to keep only in memory. So he wrote.

Not every sentence was a perfect record of what had been said. Some conversations had to be rebuilt. Some feelings had to be described. Some moments had to be slowed down so he could understand them. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. But the truth underneath remained his. His life. His mistakes. His memories. His school. His people. His year. He wanted to remember.

That was enough. Otiano saved the document. Then he looked at the screen for a long time. Maybe one day someone else would read it. Maybe nobody would. But the story existed now. And once a story exists, the past cannot disappear in exactly the same way.

20. The Wrong Table

What is yours is on the table. Make sure you are not sitting at the wrong table. Otiano eventually understood the title. Where I Am Not Supposed to Be. At first, he had thought it was about school. He had been removed from the place where he thought he belonged. He had been sent somewhere he believed was worse. He had looked around and seen students struggling to pay fees while he could spend the same amount on a single dinner. He had thought, This is not my place. But the year taught him that a place is not always defined by money. Greenspring had not been the place he expected. Yet it had given him people he would never forget.

It had given him a friendship with Irene. It had given him Olivier. Otiano did not have the language for everything he was feeling then. He only knew the sensation: something had changed, and there was no way to return to the exact person he had been before it changed. It had given him Nanette and the pain of an ending. It had given him Delice and a love that was not returned in the way he wanted. It had given him Sarada and a love he was trying to learn. It had given him Lavie and a lesson about trust. It had given him the secret of Katia. It had given him Mamy's fake party. It had given him the first page of a story. Maybe the wrong table was not a school. Maybe the wrong table was any place where you sit while pretending to be someone you are not. Otiano closed his computer.

He remembered something he had come to believe: What is yours is on the table. The ordinary details mattered too. A uniform, a classroom, a walk home, a conversation between friends—small things become heavy with meaning when you know, later, that they belonged to a finished chapter. Make sure you are not sitting at the wrong table. He did not know what would happen next. He did not know where Sarada would take him. He did not know whether the love he was trying to build would become the love he had once felt. He did not know where Delice would be years from now. He did not know what Irene and Olivier would

become abroad. He did not know what kind of lawyer he might one day become. He knew only one thing. The year was over. The story was written.

And the future was still blank.